

This pile of "e-waste" has the potential to spread so much knowledge, if given the chance

sive reduction in corruption (http://dgit.in/1vudyqe) and is the perfect model for any mobile-based money transfer system currently in existence.

Education for all

As important as the flow of money is the flow of information and in this regard, again, the mobile phone is key. Again, taking the case of Africa, the UN and other organizations have worked with various governments to provide necessary information to the people in SMS form. This information can be best practices with regards to farming, weather forecasts, advice on crop rotation, commodity prices, etc.

An education is pointless if you're too hungry to care, but once we work past satisfying that hunger, satisfying an intellectual hunger is easier. Again, the mobile phone is key here and companies like Google and Intel have spent billions in trying to develop devices and services that will see a cheap, sustainable flow of information to all parts of the world.

We've seen a rapid rise in online education portals like Khan Academy and Harward's Open Courseware, among others, but all these services suffer from the same fundamental problem as with farming. A famine of the mind is more because of an inability to access information rather than a limitation on the availability of information. The logistics just don't exist.

Statistics show that the bulk of students on Khan Academy and the like are students that already have access to basic education and who are looking to further their knowledge. None of these institutes have succeeded in addressing the real problem that's associated with education, namely, the challenge of educating the offline world.

Earn your tech karma

We might be just that little bit complacent when it comes to information, believing that we, with our high-speed 3G networks and 10mbps broadband have all the knowledge that we could ever want at our finger-tips, but that flow of information applies to us just as it much as it does a poor farmer on some remote farm on the other end of the world. Are you aware of that farmer's existence? Are you aware of the sort of help that you can provide that farmer? What if that old phone that's been lying unused in your drawer can change someone's life forever? Wouldn't that "sacrifice" be worth the effort?

It's time to start caring, to nudge ourselves out of this, some might say, tech-induced stupor, to move on from just simply "liking" UNESCO's page to actually doing something about it, to teach a young child that 8*2.5 is 20, to give a farmer the means to purchase some much-needed fertilizers, to teach a mother how to keep her new born alive.

It's not that hard, it needn't be that hard. Donate your old hardware, donate your knowledge and your skills; spare a moment of your time to making this world a better place. Don't let negligence ruin a world that has so much to offer!

If you're interested, and you should be, turn over to part three of our story to learn about how you can help and contribute. Remember, every little bit helps, no matter how small. You have it in you to bring succour to this world, earn your tech karma!

